

# JobXApply — Application Question Bank & Autofill Mapping

What job portals actually ask beyond name/email/phone, mapped to how the autofill engine should handle each type

The Autofill Engine Spec already covers structured fields (name, email, education, experience). This document extends it to the other half of most applications: screening questions, knockout questions, and open-ended essay prompts -- researched against real ATS platforms (Greenhouse, Workday) and catalogued by employment-status segment, with an explicit rule for each category on whether the engine may auto-fill it, must suggest-and-confirm, or must never touch it at all.

**Core principle carried over from the Autofill Engine Spec:** structured facts (name, degree, dates) can be auto-filled with high confidence. Everything in this document is different -- it's either a judgment call (salary expectations), a legal/eligibility statement (work authorization), or open-ended writing (why do you want this role). None of these should be auto-filled the way a phone number is. Each category below gets its own explicit handling rule rather than being treated like a normal field.

## 1. The Six Categories of Application Questions

| Category                      | What it is                                                                  | Real examples                                                                                                                                                        |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Knockout / eligibility        | Yes/No or short-select questions used to filter candidates early            | Work authorization status, sponsorship needs now/future, willingness to relocate, on-site requirement, required certification confirmation, background-check consent |
| Compensation                  | Salary-related, sometimes range-matching                                    | Expected salary/CTC, current salary/CTC, "does this range work for you"                                                                                              |
| Logistics                     | Timing and availability                                                     | Notice period, start date availability, willingness to travel, shift/weekend availability                                                                            |
| Experience screening          | Confirms specific qualifications the resume alone doesn't structure cleanly | Years of experience in a specific skill, "do you have X certification", specific tool/language proficiency confirmation                                              |
| EEO / demographic (voluntary) | Equal-opportunity tracking, legally must be optional where asked            | Gender, veteran status, disability status, race/ethnicity -- far more common on US-headquartered/MNC applications than pure India-market ones                        |
| Open-ended / essay            | Free-text boxes requiring real writing, not a lookup                        | Why do you want to work here, why should we hire you, tell us about yourself, describe relevant experience                                                           |

## 2. How the Right Answer Changes by Employment-Status Segment

The question wording is usually the same across candidates -- what changes is which answer is true and how it should be phrased. The engine needs a per-user "employment status" setting in the Profile to get this right, not a one-size-fits-all default.

| Segment                                     | What's different about a true, good answer                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Availability default                                                | Notice period default                                              |
|---------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Student / final-year, no job yet            | Availability is usually "after [graduation month]", not immediate. Notice period is typically "N/A" or "immediate" since there's no current employer. Experience-screening questions often need an honest "0 years professional, but X months internship/project experience" framing rather than a blank. | Immediate / date-based, tied to Profile's education end date        | N/A -- flag as such rather than leaving blank or guessing a number |
| Unemployed, actively seeking                | Availability is usually immediate. Notice period is N/A. Reason-for-gap questions (if asked) need a factual, non-defensive framing pulled from what the user has actually stated, never invented.                                                                                                         | Immediate                                                           | N/A                                                                |
| Employed, applying while working            | Notice period is a real, specific number pulled from the user's actual current-employment terms (Profile preference), not guessed from "industry average." Availability follows the notice period, not immediate.                                                                                         | Start date = today + notice period                                  | Pulled from Profile preferences.noticePeriod -- never inferred     |
| Career switcher / re-entering after a break | Experience-screening questions in the NEW target domain often need an honest "transferable experience" framing rather than a flat "0 years," since a literal 0 can trigger an automatic knockout rejection even when the person is a reasonable candidate.                                                | Depends on current employment status (use the applicable row above) | Depends on current employment status                               |

This segment setting lives in Profile.preferences (already defined in the Profile Schema doc) as an explicit field -- **employmentStatus**: student / unemployed / employed / career-switcher -- set once by the user, not inferred from resume content, since inferring something this consequential wrongly is worse than asking directly.

### 3. Autofill Handling Rule Per Category

| Category               | Rule                                                     | Why                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Knockout / eligibility | SUGGEST, NEVER AUTO-FILL                                 | These are legal/factual statements with real consequences (a wrong sponsorship answer can end an application instantly, or worse, create a real problem if dishonest). The engine pre-fills from a one-time "Application Preferences" section the user explicitly fills in once (work authorization status, sponsorship needs, relocation willingness) -- but every instance is shown for confirmation before submission, never silently submitted. |
| Compensation           | SUGGEST FROM PROFILE, NEVER INVENT                       | Pulled only from Profile.preferences.expectedSalary / currentSalary if the user has set them. If unset, the field is left empty and flagged -- the engine must never estimate a number the user hasn't provided, even from market-rate data, since that number carries real negotiation consequences.                                                                                                                                               |
| Logistics              | AUTO-FILL FROM PROFILE, FLAG FOR REVIEW                  | Notice period and availability follow the segment rules in Section 2, computed from Profile data the user already set (current employment status, notice period). Medium confidence by default -- always shown in the review chip, same as any other autofill result.                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Experience screening   | AUTO-FILL WHEN THE PROFILE ANSWERS IT DIRECTLY           | If the Profile already contains a quantified skill (e.g. "3 years Java" derivable from experience dates + listed skill), auto-fill with normal confidence scoring. If it requires a judgment call not directly in the Profile, treat as a knockout question instead (suggest, don't auto-fill).                                                                                                                                                     |
| EEO / demographic      | NEVER AUTO-FILL, ALWAYS USER-INITIATED                   | These are optional by design and sensitive. The engine should never pre-fill them at all, regardless of confidence -- the user answers directly on the portal, every time, if they choose to answer at all.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Open-ended / essay     | AI-ASSISTED DRAFT, ALWAYS EDITABLE, NEVER AUTO-SUBMITTED | See Section 4 -- this is the most involved category and gets its own generation logic.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |

### 4. Open-Ended Question Handling (the hard case)

Questions like "Why do you want to work here?" or "Why should we hire you?" can't be looked up -- they need generated text. This reuses the same real-facts-only constraint already established for the Cover Letter Generator and the ATS Checker's suggestion engine.

1. DETECT -> autofill engine identifies the field as free-text/essay type (long textarea, no structured input pattern, matched against a bank of common open-ended question phrasings -- "why", "tell us about", "describe")
2. CONTEXT -> gather: user's Profile (experience, skills, summary), the specific job's title/company (scraped from the portal page being filled), and if available, the job description text
3. DRAFT -> generate a short draft (2-4 sentences) using ONLY facts already in the user's Profile -- no invented achievements, no invented motivations not grounded in something the user has actually stated
4. SHOW -> insert the draft into the field but keep it visually marked as a suggestion (same treatment as a low-confidence field) -- cursor placed in the field, draft fully editable, nothing is final until the user reviews it
5. NEVER -> auto-submit the form after filling an essay field -- this is already the universal rule for every field, but it matters most here since generated text is the most likely category to need real editing

**Common open-ended question phrasings the engine should recognize:**

- "Why do you want to work at [Company]?" / "Why this role?"
- "Why should we hire you?" / "What makes you a good fit?"
- "Tell us about yourself" / "Walk us through your background"
- "Describe your relevant experience for this role"
- "What are you looking for in your next role?"
- Cover-letter-style prompts embedded directly in the application form rather than as a separate upload

## 5. Consolidated Question Bank (Real Phrasings, by Category)

| Category             | Real-world phrasing                                                                         |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Knockout             | Are you legally authorized to work in [Country]?                                            |
| Knockout             | Will you now or in the future require visa sponsorship?                                     |
| Knockout             | Are you willing to relocate to [Location]?                                                  |
| Knockout             | This role requires working on-site during normal business hours -- are you able to do this? |
| Knockout             | Are you willing to work [specific shift/weekend pattern]?                                   |
| Knockout             | Do you consent to a background check as part of this process?                               |
| Compensation         | What is your expected salary / CTC for this role?                                           |
| Compensation         | What is your current salary / CTC?                                                          |
| Compensation         | The salary range for this role is [X-Y] -- does this align with your expectations?          |
| Logistics            | What is your notice period?                                                                 |
| Logistics            | When are you available to start?                                                            |
| Logistics            | Are you willing to travel for this role, and if so, how much?                               |
| Experience screening | How many years of experience do you have with [specific skill]?                             |
| Experience screening | Do you hold [specific certification]?                                                       |
| Experience screening | Rate your proficiency with [tool/language] (scale question)                                 |
| EEO / demographic    | Gender (optional)                                                                           |
| EEO / demographic    | Are you a person with a disability? (optional)                                              |
| EEO / demographic    | Veteran status (optional)                                                                   |
| Open-ended           | Why do you want to work at [Company]?                                                       |
| Open-ended           | Why should we hire you for this role?                                                       |
| Open-ended           | Tell us about yourself.                                                                     |
| Open-ended           | Describe your relevant experience for this position.                                        |

*This question bank is a living list -- new phrasings should be added from real user-reported portal encounters over time, the same way the Portal Playbooks document is meant to evolve from real field-map breakage reports.*